brothers) phase in the early 1950s, India was considered as an instrument of Western imperialism. Its independence and non-alignment were said to be only in name. The Tibet crisis in 1959 led to another phase of very negative reporting on India, including the infamous *People's Daily* article, attributed to Mao himself, entitled 'On Nehru's Philosophy'. This long article, which appeared on 6 May 1959, accused Nehru of harbouring ulterior intent towards Tibet and undermining Chinese sovereignty over what China considered its own sovereign territory. Later, on 27 October 1962, in the aftermath of the first wave of attacks on the Sino-Indian border, the *People's Daily* published another long diatribe against Nehru, entitled 'More on Nehru's Philosophy in the Light of the Sino-Indian Boundary Question'. This later article quoted from Nehru's book, *The Discovery of India* , to argue: 'The goal pursued by this ambitious Nehru is the establishment of a great empire unprecedented in history.'

The article refers to Nehru as a 'lackey of the imperialists'. [10]

But it is in the record of several private conversations which Chinese leaders had with foreign interlocutors that the attitude of contempt against India comes out most clearly. I will cite here some of Zhou Enlai's observations about India and Nehru in conversations with Kissinger in 1972.

Zhou referred to Nehru's *Discovery of India* , saying that Nehru was thinking of a great Indian empire, but 'actually India is a bottomless hole'. [11]

> Zhou: India is a highly suspicious country. It is quite a big country, sometimes it puts on airs of a big country, but sometimes it has an inferiority complex.
>
> Kissinger: It has been governed by foreigners through most of its history.
>
> Zhou: Yes, that might be one of the historical factors.
>
> Zhou: . . . Nehru invited me to a tea party in his garden among the guests were two people in costume. There were two Tibetan lamas and suddenly there appeared a female lama. Do you know who she was?
>
> Kissinger: Madame Binh?
>
> Zhou: Madame Gandhi (laughter). She was dressed up entirely in Tibetan costume. That was something that Nehru was capable of doing . . . I was speechless confronted with such a situation. It was impossible for me to say anything. [12]

For Zhou, Mrs Gandhi donning a Tibetan costume while he was present was proof that India coveted Tibet! That India too is home to communities